08-20 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Middle Schools Start the School Day Later?

① At our school, the first class every morning begins at **7:40 a.m.** That means many students must wake up at **6:10**, eat a quick breakfast, and rush to the gate by 7:25. In the cold months, we walk into the classroom under a dark sky, our eyes still half closed. Recently, a few parents have asked a simple question at the parent meeting: **should middle schools start later, say 8:30 a.m.?** Some teachers like the idea; others do not. I believe a later start — even by 30 or 45 minutes — would help most middle-school students.

② Let me first describe the problem clearly. Middle-school students aged 12 to 15 need **about 9 hours** of sleep every night, according to health experts. But most of my classmates sleep only 6 or 7 hours because of homework, evening clubs and social apps. The result is that many of us sit in the first-period class half asleep. We hear the teacher's voice, but our brains do not really take it in. By the second class, we start waking up; by the third, we are finally ready to learn. The most expensive class in the day — the first period — becomes the least useful.

③ People who do not want to change the start time have reasons too. They say that a later school morning means a later end of the school day, so students will finish clubs, sports and homework even later. Some parents worry about their own work: they drop their children at school before going to work themselves. A teacher once told me, "If we start at 8:30, my whole family plan will change." These voices deserve calm listening.

④ However, the gain of a later start may be bigger than the cost. Many Western schools have tried moving the first class from 7:45 to 8:30. Reports from these schools show **three clear benefits**. First, students pay more attention in class; test scores in maths and languages go up on average. Second, fewer students fall asleep at their desks, so teachers spend less time waking them up. Third, students report feeling **less sad and tired**, which matters very much at a time when teenage health is a common worry.

⑤ The parents' timing worries are fair, but they can be solved. Schools can open the school gate earlier — say, at 7:10 — and offer a quiet reading room or a safe breakfast room for students whose parents really need to leave home early. In this way, the parents' work life is not broken, while most students still get that extra half hour of real sleep.

⑥ As for the "later end of day" worry, it is partly a misunderstanding. If we keep the same number of class periods but start 30 minutes later, the school day ends only 30

minutes later. We can also remove or shorten one period that is less used today, such as the long afternoon break. Even if evening homework is pushed back a little, the main point is: **30 more minutes of morning sleep are worth far more than 30 more minutes of late-night half-study**.

⑦ I am not arguing that all schools should begin at 9:30 or 10:00. I also do not think that a later start will solve every student's tiredness. Sleep also needs to be protected at night: too many phones, too much late TV, and too much cold tea will still ruin any good morning. But **moving the first class from around 7:40 to 8:10 or 8:30** would respect what we know about teenage sleep, without turning school life upside down.

⑧ So, should middle schools start later? My answer is: yes, with small, careful steps. A school that pays attention to how its students' brains really work is a school that truly respects learning. And sometimes the easiest way to help students think better is simply to give them thirty more quiet minutes with a pillow.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the writer's main view?

A. Middle schools should keep the present start time, 7:40 a.m.
B. Middle schools should start the first class later, even by only 30 or 45 minutes.
C. Middle schools should start as early as 6:30 a.m. so students have more study time.
D. Schools should cancel the morning class and only hold afternoon classes.

2. According to the passage, how many hours of sleep should a 12—15-year-old student get each night?

A. About 5 hours.
B. About 7 hours.
C. About 9 hours.
D. About 12 hours.

3. Which is NOT one of the benefits reported by schools that moved their start time from 7:45 to 8:30?

A. Students pay more attention in class and test scores go up.
B. Fewer students fall asleep at their desks.
C. Students say they feel less sad and tired.
D. Every student becomes a top-ranking student in class.

4. How does the writer answer the parents' worry that they must drop children off before work?

A. By saying that those parents should change their jobs.
B. By saying the school can open the gate earlier and offer a quiet reading or breakfast

room for students who come early.
C. By saying parents should stop working.
D. By saying the children should stay at school overnight.

5. What is the writer's attitude toward those who oppose a later start?

A. The writer mocks them and calls them lazy.
B. The writer calmly listens to their reasons, calls them "fair", and then offers practical answers to each one.
C. The writer completely ignores them.
D. The writer says they do not care about students.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第①段末 "a later start — even by 30 or 45 minutes — would help most middle-school students" & 第⑧段 "yes, with small, careful steps"
【解析】作者立场鲜明：支持小幅度推迟。A、C、D 均与立场相反或不符。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "about 9 hours of sleep every night"
【解析】原文明确 9 小时。A、B、D 均与数据不符。故选 C。

3.
【答案】D
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段列举三项益处
【解析】文中只列成绩提升、上课不打瞌睡、减少疲惫悲伤三项，并未说"每个学生都成班级第一"，属过度推断。A、B、C 均为原文列出的好处。故选 D。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "open the school gate earlier ... a quiet reading room or a safe breakfast room"
【解析】作者提议提早开门、提供安全早读/早餐空间。A、C、D 均与原文不符。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】写作态度题

【定位】第③段 "These voices deserve calm listening" & 第⑤⑥段针对性回应
【解析】作者认真倾听反对意见并一一回答。A、C、D 均与作者语气不符。故选 B。